

You can also customise search within the manual for file format and section number. Here is a simple syntax for this:

- `man section search _term`

And, with real values:

- `[me@linuxbox ~]$ man 5 passwd`

This will give us the file format from `/etc/passwd` file respectively on the screen.

- `apropos - search appropriate commands`

You can make a specific search on man pages for a particular term. Though used rarely, it can be useful sometimes. Check out the example for search in man pages with the search term for 'floppy'.

- `[me@linuxbox ~]$ apropos floppy`
- `create _floppy _devices (8) - udev callout to create all possible`
- `floppy device based on the CMOS type`
- `fdformat (8) - Low-level formats a floppy disk`
- `floppy (8) - format floppy disks`
- `gfloppy (1) - a simple floppy formatter for the GNOME`
- `mbadblocks(1) - tests a floppy disk, and marks the bad blocks in the FAT`
- `mformat(1) - add an MSDOS filesystem to a low-level`
- `formatted floppy disk`

whatis – provides a small description for a command

The `whatis` program, when used results in the name and a short description of a man page that matches a particular keyword. The syntax for `whatis` program is:

- `whatis [-dlhvV] [-r|-w] [-s list] [-m system[,...]] [-M path] [-L locale]`
- `[-C file] name ...`

Info pages provide information to users and are hyperlinked just as web pages and that allows them to move from one node to another. These are tree-structured with individual nodes, each containing a specific topic. You can use the `info` command by typing `info` and then followed by the program name to get a specific info page. Here is the list of options for `info` commands: